

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

High School Foundations | Unit 4

Prefix semi-



Today I am learning that the prefix semi- often means half or partly.

1 Learn the Meaning

The prefix semi- often carries the idea half or partly. In academic and technical words, it can describe something that is half of a whole, partly in a state, or intermediate between two conditions.

semicircle
half of a circle

semipermeable
allows some substances through

semisolid
partly solid

semiconscious
partly conscious

2 Build the Word

Add semi- to the base or related word. Build the new word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / related	Add	New word	Meaning clue
circle	semi-		
solid	semi-		
permeable	semi-		
conscious	semi-		
aquatic	semi-		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

During a science investigation, students compared different materials and living things to see how they behaved. They observed that some substances were semisolid, neither fully liquid nor fully solid, which made them useful in products like gels and creams. They also examined a semipermeable membrane, which allowed certain substances to pass through while blocking others.

The class then learned about semiconductors, special materials that conduct electricity only partially and are used in computers and other electronic devices. They also studied semiaquatic animals, such as frogs, which live partly in water and partly on land, and discussed how their adaptations help them survive in both environments.

Finally, the students looked at a diagram showing a semicircle and considered how it represents half of a full circle. They also read a case study about an accident victim who was semiconscious, meaning awake but not fully conscious, and discussed the importance of careful monitoring in such situations.



Highlight the semi- words. Underline the base or related word, then decide whether semi- means half or partly.

4 Word Detective

Choose one semi- word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write a semi- word from the passage.

- What base or related word can you identify?

- Does semi- mean half or partly in this word?

- Explain how the prefix helps you understand the whole word.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by the meaning clue carried by semi-.

semicircle

semicircular

semidiameter

semiellipse

semisolid

semipermeable

semiconductor

semiconscious

Half of a whole

Partly / intermediate

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- The prefix semi- helps me understand that _____

- Use one semi- word in a sentence that shows whether it means half or partly.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises semi- as meaning half / partly
- ☐ Identifies a base or related word
- ☐ Explains how the prefix changes the whole-word meaning
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



Capture idea:

Find a semi- word in a science, geometry or information text. Record the word, identify the base, and explain whether the prefix means half or partly.